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UAE CALLS FOR FIRM STANCE ON IRAN

Gargash urges united GCC stand after Iran attack on Kuwait airport kills 1

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

An Iranian attack killed an Indian national and injured 63 people at Kuwait's international airport, forcing it to close temporarily, in the first deadly strike on the Gulf since an April 8 ceasefire came into place.

Bahrain authorities said they intercepted three missiles and a number of drones launched by Iran.

The attacks, which Kuwait said also damaged unnamed diplomatic missions, have put fresh strain on a ceasefire that had largely held despite sporadic exchanges of fire between Iran and the United States.

The injured included civilians, airport workers and travellers. The Indian foreign ministry confirmed that one of its citizens was killed and condemned the strike. An airport source told AFP that the deceased was a traveller.

The UAE has strongly condemned the Iranian terrorist attacks. In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs described the attacks as a blatant violation of Kuwait's sovereignty and a breach of international law.

Standing together

In a post on X, Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, called for a firm and united GCC position against the repeated Iranian aggression against Kuwait and Bahrain, saying the security and interests of GCC countries are inseparable.

Gargash said GCC countries must stand together in the face of regional threats and warned against leaving any state to confront attacks on its own.

"In light of the repeated Iranian aggression against our sister states, Kuwait and Bahrain, there must be a firm, unified and cohesive GCC position," Gargash said.

Kuwait stressed that its territory and airspace were not



Kuwait Prime Minister Sheikh Ahmad Abdullah Al Ahmad Al Sabah conducts an inspection visit to the passenger building (T1) at Kuwait International Airport yesterday.
KUNA

used to launch attacks against any country, rejecting Iranian claims. The attacks triggered a wave of regional condemnation, with Gulf and Arab governments rallying behind Kuwait and Bahrain and accusing Tehran of threatening regional security and stability.

Missiles, drones launched

Kuwait's defence ministry spokesman Saud Abdulaziz Al Atwan said 30 ballistic missiles and drones were launched as part of what he described as "heinous Iranian aggression", causing significant damage to the airport terminal building.

Air traffic partially resumed later in the day and Kuwait Airways announced the gradual restoration of services. The airport had only fully resumed operations on June 1 after months

of disruption linked to the war. The US military said it had "successfully defeated" a series of Iranian missile and drone attacks across the Gulf and carried out self-defence strikes on Iran's Qeshm Island. US Central Command also rejected Iranian claims that the headquarters of the US Navy's Fifth Fleet in Bahrain and another regional air base had been hit.

Amid the renewed tensions, US President Donald Trump said he hopes to meet Iran's Supreme Leader Mojtaba Khamenei. "He's involved, absolutely," Trump said in an interview with Pod Force One when asked whether Khamenei was directly participating in efforts to reach an agreement with the US. "I think they have a lot of respect for him."

SEE ALSO P4, 6-10

IAEA: ATTACK ON BARAKAH A 'TRIAL BY FIRE'

Rafael Mariano Grossi, the Director General of the International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA), has reiterated the agency's unequivocal opposition to any attack on peaceful nuclear facilities, stressing that such installations are fully protected under international humanitarian law.

Grossi made the remarks during a press conference on Tuesday, following a site visit to the Barakah Nuclear Energy Plant as part of a regional tour.

During the visit, he reviewed the measures implemented to ensure the continued safe operation of the facility in the aftermath of the attack on May 17, 2026.

The IAEA chief commended the close cooperation demonstrated by the UAE authorities, noting that the agency received accurate, timely and regular technical updates regarding the consequences of the attack. This, he said, enabled the IAEA to monitor developments in real time and maintain full situational awareness.

Grossi concluded that the plant's safety systems and operational procedures functioned exactly as intended. "This was a trial by fire for them, and they passed it with flying colours," he said.

—Abdulla Rasheed, Abu Dhabi Editor



21

people were killed in a fire at a Delhi hotel

26

among 47 people rescued remained under treatment

17

among the 21 people killed were foreign nationals

Medical travellers dead in Delhi fire

Foreign patients, attendants among those killed in Delhi hotel blaze

DUBAI
BY ALEX ABRAHAM
Senior Associate Editor

Seventeen foreign nationals who had travelled to India for medical treatment or to accompany relatives were among the 21 people killed in a fire at a Delhi hotel, police said, as investigators widened their probe into the building's safety measures and ownership.

The victims were largely from Liberia, Nigeria, Mozambique and Bangladesh and were staying at a bed-and-breakfast opposite a major hospital in south Delhi's Malviya Nagar area.

Police have registered a

culpable homicide case and launched a search for the hotel's owner. Investigators are examining whether the property had the necessary permissions to operate and whether safety norms were followed.

Scenes of panic

The fire broke out yesterday morning at Flourish Stay, trapping dozens of occupants inside the multi-storey building. Witnesses described scenes of panic as guests tried to escape through smoke-filled corridors, with some jumping from upper floors onto mattresses spread on the street below by local residents.

Officials said 47 people were rescued from the build-

ing, while 26 remained under treatment. Among the injured were 10 Delhi Police personnel who were among the first responders to enter the burning structure and help evacuate guests.

Questions are also being raised about reports that the hotel had limited exit routes and poor ventilation. Authorities have yet to determine the cause of the fire.

The tragedy has renewed scrutiny of safety standards at guest houses and budget hotels, particularly those clustered around major hospitals where vulnerable patients and their families often seek affordable accommodation.

SEE ALSO P12

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24-hour notice for KHDA school inspections

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

From the next academic year, private schools in Dubai will be inspected with no more than 24 hours' notice before a quality assurance team arrives, the emirate's education authority revealed yesterday.

Dubai's Knowledge and Human Development Authority (KHDA) announced the resumption of quality assurance visits for private schools from the 2026-27 academic year, introducing two types of visits.

The first is a full inspection by a team of specialist experts, resulting in a comprehensive report with an overall school rating. The second is a shorter monitoring visit by a smaller team, focusing on specific areas identified through data analysis, with no new overall rating issued.

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